GOVERNMENT OF DUBAI

هيئة كهرباء ومياه دبي
Dubai Electricity & Water Authority

DEWA User Interface Design Guidelines

A comprehensive UI design guide for the DEWA official website and mobile app

Version 1.2



Color 1/2

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

DEWA is committed to comply with the AAA standard contrast ratios. The color palette has thus been adapted to provide the best visibility across all our channels and platforms.

Color Palette

Primary

Primary	Dark	Gradient
HEX | #087B36 RGB | 8 123 54	HEX | #065726 RGB | 6 87 38	HEX 1 | #065726 HEX 2 | #087B36

Neutrals

Primary Font	Secondary Font	Inactive Icons & Disabled fields
HEX | #3F3F3F RGB | 63 63 63	HEX | #717173 RGB | 147 149 152	HEX | #9B9B9B RGB | 155 155 155

Page Background	Cards & Other Backgrounds
HEX | #F1F1F1 RGB | 241 241 241	HEX | #FFFFFF RGB | 255 255 255

Color 2/2

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

DEWA is committed to comply with the AAA standard contrast ratios. The color palette has thus been adapted to provide the best visibility across all our channels and platforms.

Color Palette (Continued)

Semantic

Error	Warning	Success	Information
HEX | #E10E49	HEX | #AC631C	HEX | #087B36	HEX | #0079C1
RGB | 225 14 73	RGB | 172 99 28	RGB | 8 123 54	RGB | 0 121 193

Graphs (Only for infographics and not text)

Green	Yellow	Orange
HEX | #087B36	HEX | #FFDA5B	HEX | #F5A623
RGB | 8 123 54	RGB | 255 218 91	RGB | 245 166 35

Red	Blue
HEX | #E10E49	HEX | #0079C1
RGB | 225 14 73	RGB | 0 121 193

Accessibility (1/8)

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

DEWA believes in making its products and services accessible for everybody. That includes people with vision, hearing or other forms of impairment. Thus everything is designed with that in mind to provide the best user experience for everyone.

Colors

All color combinations used in the products for text must at minimum pass the AA standard contrast ratios i.e. have a minimum ratio of 4:5:1 or pass AAA standards where possible

Usage

#268126 #FFFFFF

Contrast ratio - 5: 38: 1 Pass

Use this

#34B233 #FFFFFF

Contrast ratio - 2: 78: 1 Fail

Don't use this

#000000 #EEEEEE

Contrast ratio - 18: 1: 1 Pass

Use this

#6D6E71 #EEEEEE

Contrast ratio - 4: 39: 1 Fail

Don't use this

Accessibility (2/8)

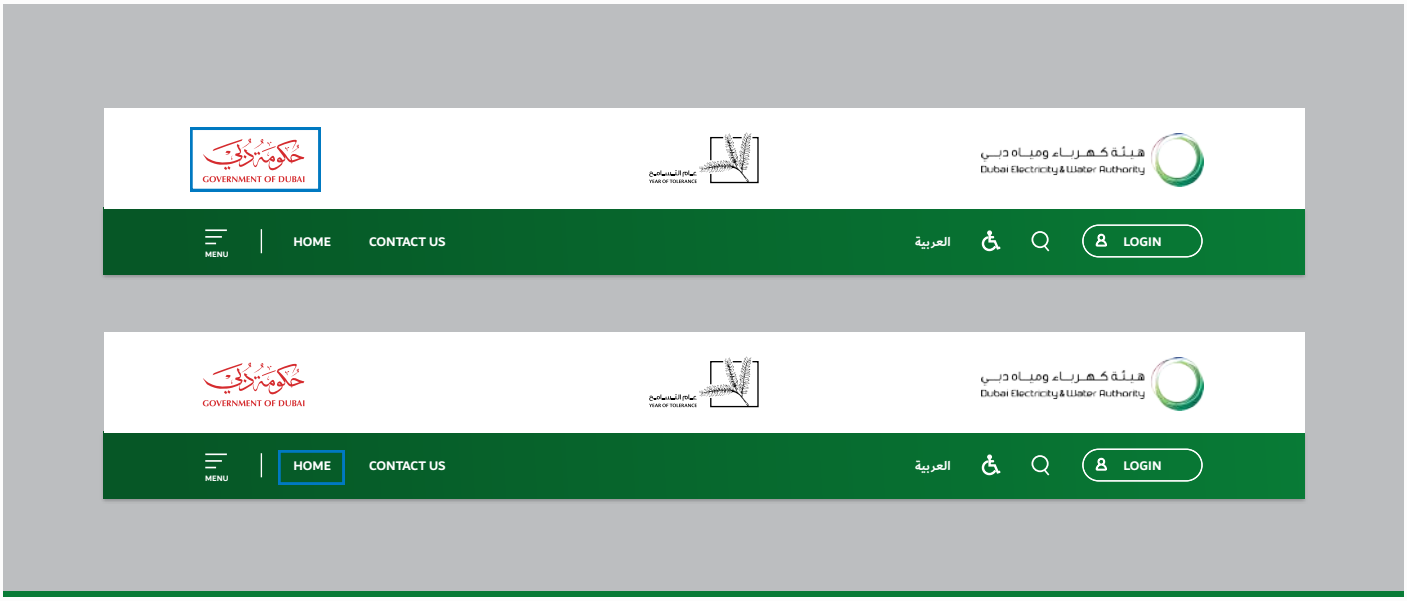
Applicable Platforms
Official Website

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Keyboard Navigation

Some users can't use a mouse. Thus everything on the page must be easy to navigate for users who only use a keyboard

Usage



Do.

- Indicate keyboard focus when navigating using a keyboard.
- Structure elements in a way that is easy to navigate without a mouse

Accessibility (3/8)

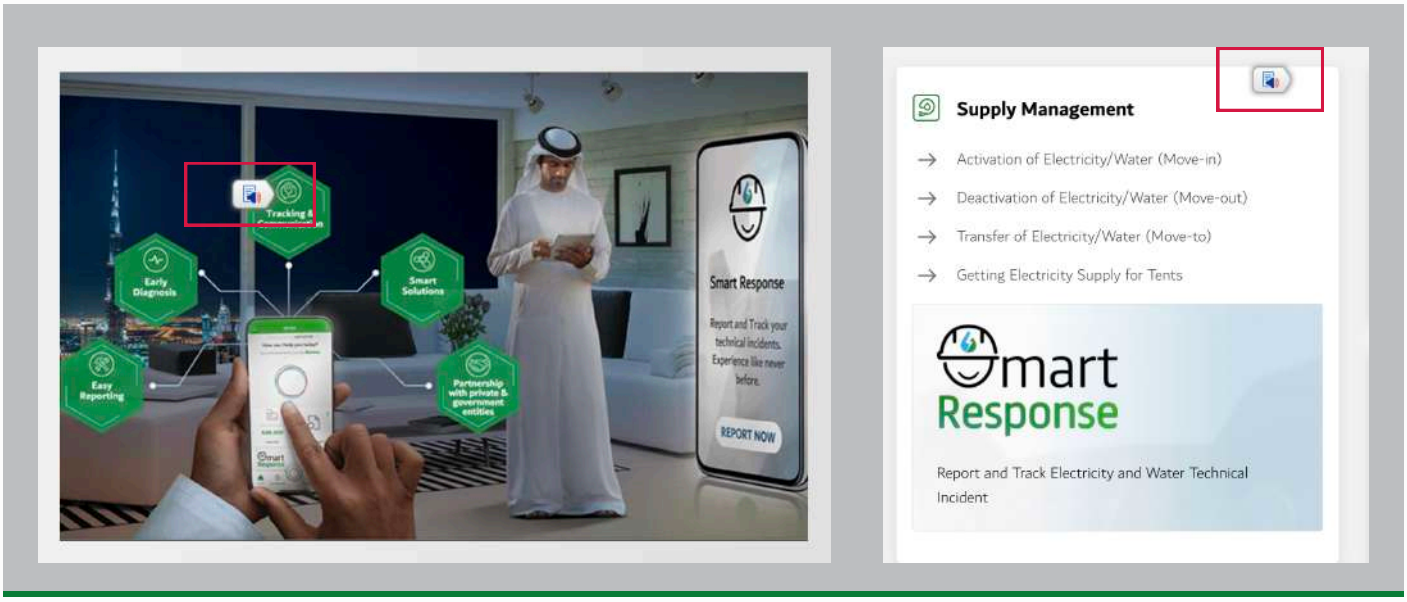
Applicable Platforms
Official Website

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Alternative Text

Some users are visually impaired and navigate websites with the use of screen readers. Thus it is important that all the content in the website has audio alternatives. A built in audio playback function is to be maintained and proper alternative text is to be provided for all images, links or any other item.

Usage



Do.

- Ensure proper alternative text is available for all content including images
- Provide an audio playback function for all content

Accessibility (4/8)

Applicable Platforms

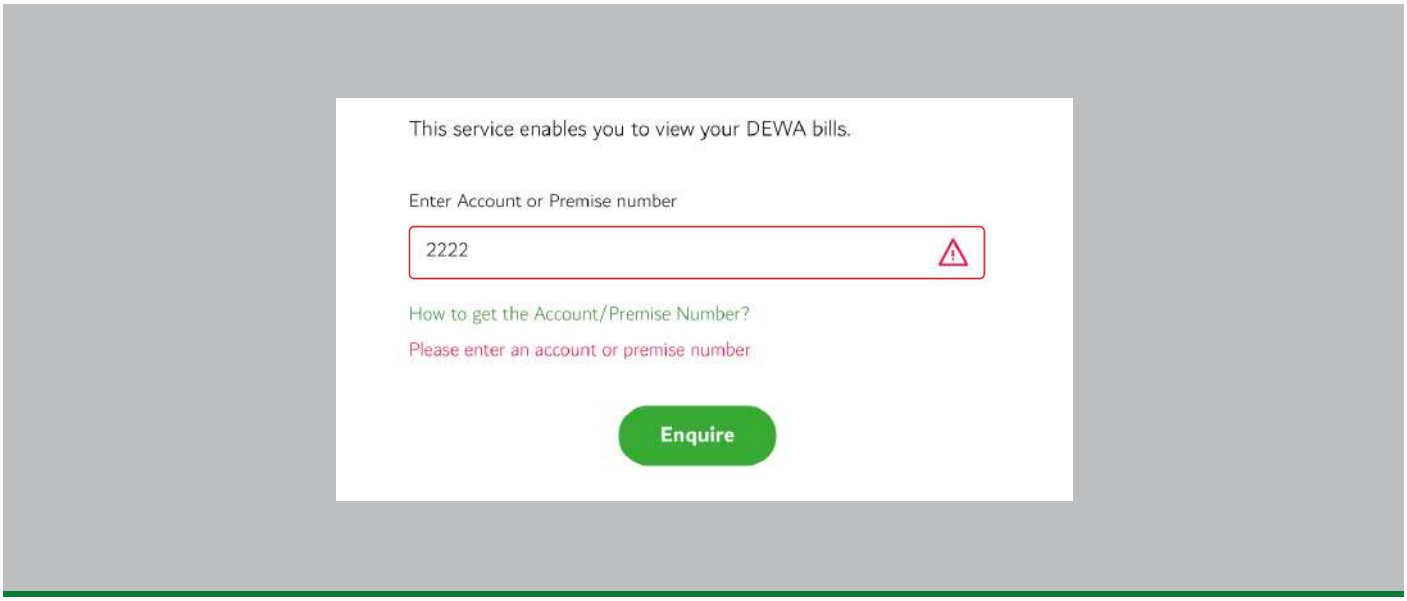
Official Website | Official App

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Forms

Validate forms inline so that users don't have to navigate far to get feedback.

Usage



Do.

• Provide short and concise information for the help text

• Ensure that error/warning/success status's are not indicated solely by color. E.g. highlighting the form field in red without any icon or any other indicator might make it difficult for color blind people to see what is wrong.

Accessibility (5/8)

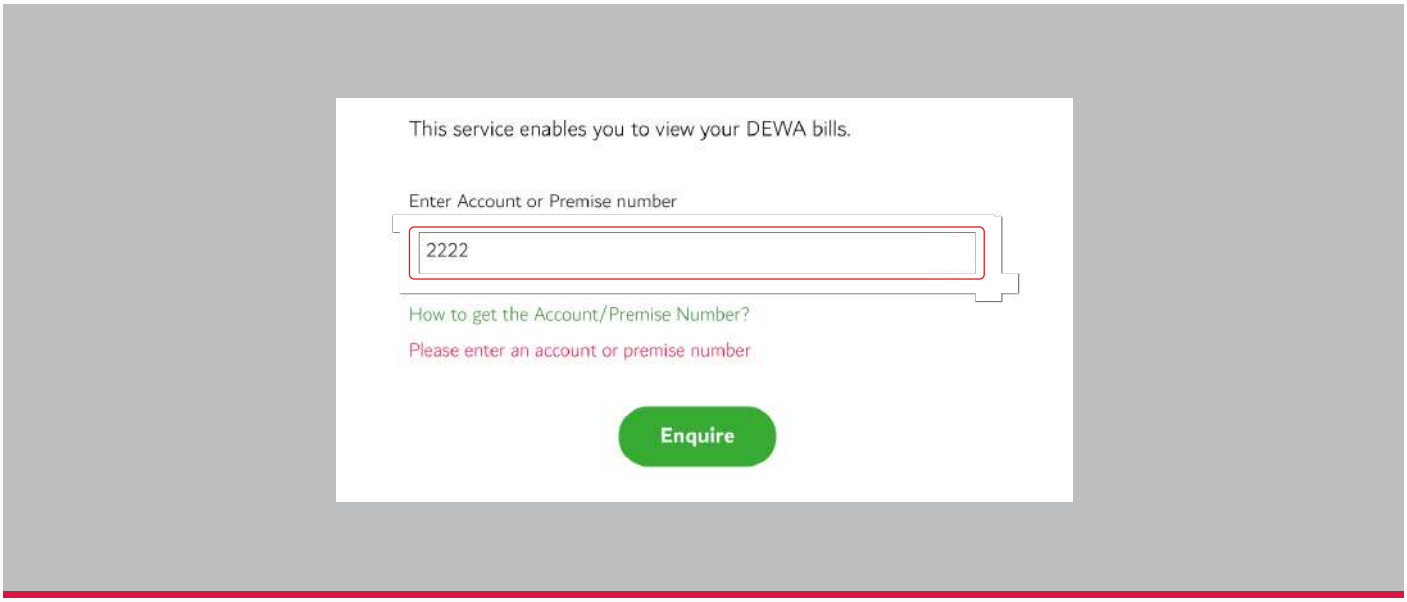
Applicable Platforms

Official Website Official App

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Forms (Continued)

Usage



Dont.

• Indicate errors with just a color

Meaningful Text

Always make sure that proper and helpful text is used consistently thoughout the application. This can be for help text, messages or any other informative text, links or UI labels so that users can navigate easily

Accessibility (6/8)

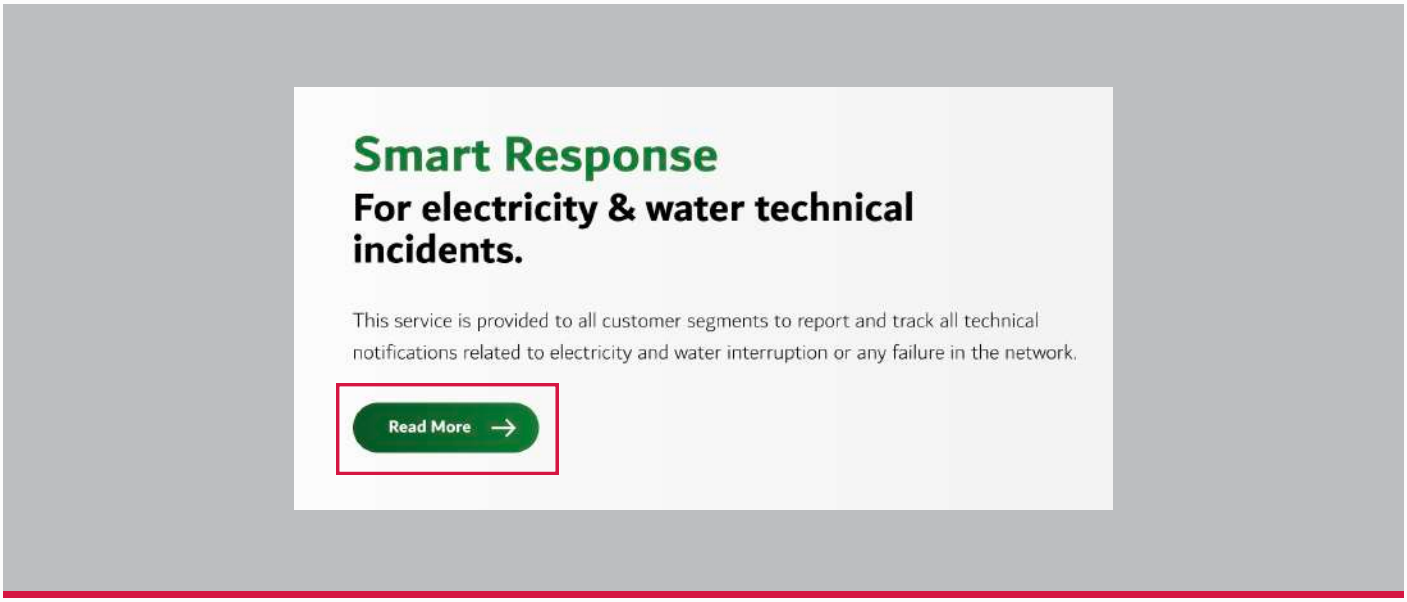
Applicable Platforms

Official Website Official App

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Meaningful Text (Continued)

Usage



Dont.

• Name links with general text. This makes it difficult for people using screenreaders to know what the link is for

Accessibility (7/8)

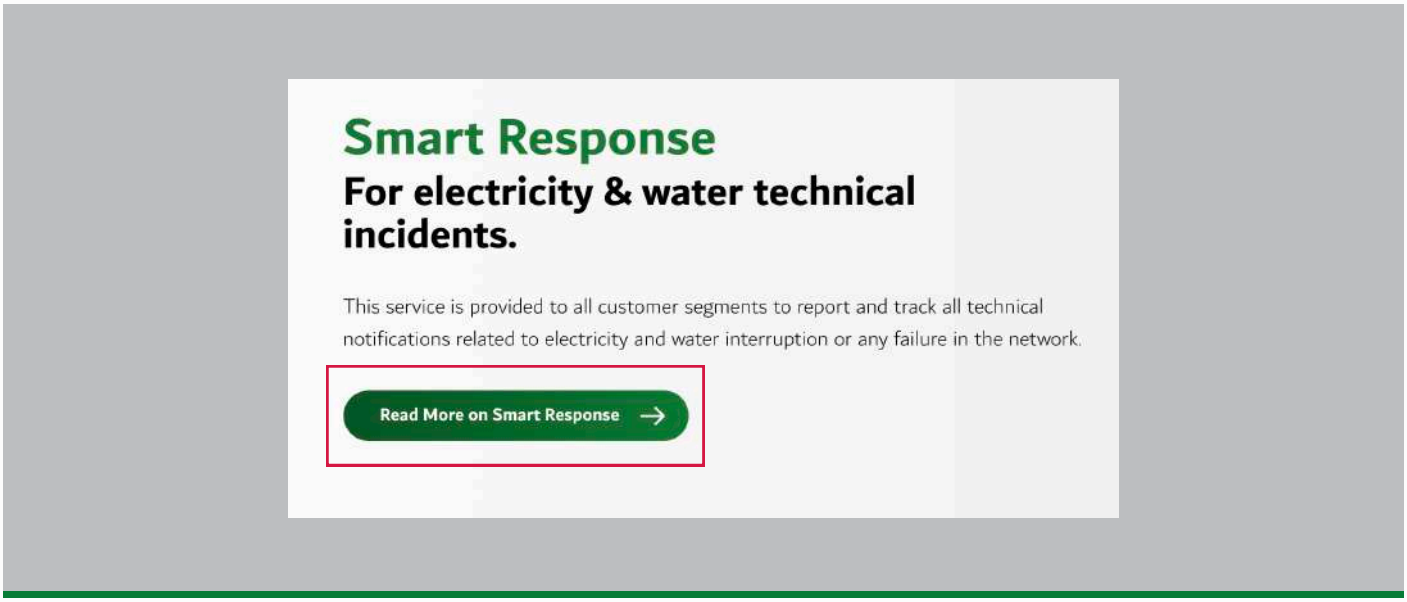
Applicable Platforms

Official Website Official App

DEWA believes in making its products and services accessible for everybody. That includes people with vision, hearing or other forms of impairment. Thus everything is designed with that in mind to provide the best user experience for everyone.

Meaningful Text (Continued)

Usage



Do.

• Name links in a way which indicate specifically what they are for

Accessibility (8/8)

Applicable Platforms

Official Website Official App

DEWA believes in making its products and services accessible for everybody. That includes people with vision, hearing or other forms of impairment. Thus everything is designed with that in mind to provide the best user experience for everyone.

Best Practices

• Always design with accessibility in mind

• Always try to exceed minimum requirements where possible e.g. go for AAA contrast ratios instead of the minimum requirement of AA standard ratios if possible

• Add functionalities or design improvements that will enhance the users experience even if it is not a requirement. E.g. use of high contrast color schemes in the website to aid visually impaired people

• When in doubt, you can refer to the following international guidelines:

https://www.w3.org/

https://webaim.org/

Typography (1/2)

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

The typeface used across DEWA channels and platforms is 'Dubai', since it has been widely adopted as a brand of Dubai. By establishing proper typographic rules and scales, we ensure all UI is highly legible and consistent.

Font Weights

Dubai Regular

Use for small to large reading passages

Primary font weight, use abundantly

Dubai Bold

Use for headings, subheadings and interaction labels (buttons, form fields)

Avoid using with all caps unless minimum font size is being used

Font Colors

#3F3F3F | Primary font color - Use this for all text unless alternate colors are specified

#717173 | Secondary font color - Use when text with lesser impact is needed to be displayed

#087B36 | Primary green - Use to show selected status, selections on hover, for links, for selected headings, for eyebrow headings. Avoid using this color excessively

Typography (2/2)

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

The typeface used across DEWA channels and platforms is 'Dubai', since it has been widely adopted as a brand of Dubai. By establishing proper typographic rules and scales, we ensure all UI is highly legible and consistent.

Font Sizes

Main Headings - 41px

Section titles - 36px

Persona titles - 25px

Service card titles - 20px

Modules (news, etc) - 18px

Base font size - 16px

Small titles/dates - 13px

Iconography 1/5

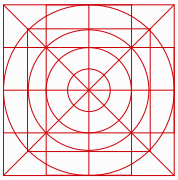
Applicable Platforms

Official Website Official App

Icons are visual representations used for services, actions, etc. to provide visual context and to enhance usability. We have set a proper foundation for creating simple, bold and aesthetically pleasing icons for DEWA.

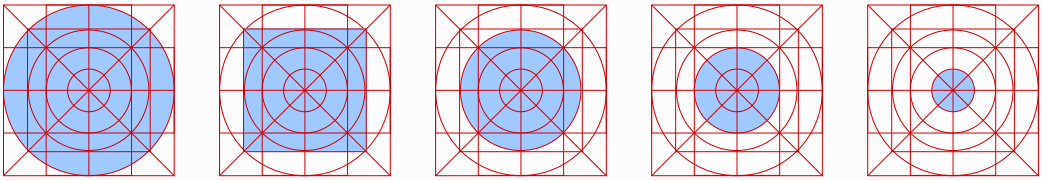
Grid

Icons are designed on a 64x64 pixel artboard with a margin of 4px to allow for breathing room. The grid serves as a guide while designing the icons and while it is important to follow it as closely as possible, it is not compulsary to follow it exactly if that means sacrificing on the aesthetics of the icon



Shapes

Always try to create the icons from basic shapes first, i.e. Squares, rectangles, triangles. Use the guidelines in the grid to maintain a visual balance throughout all the icons



Iconography 2/5

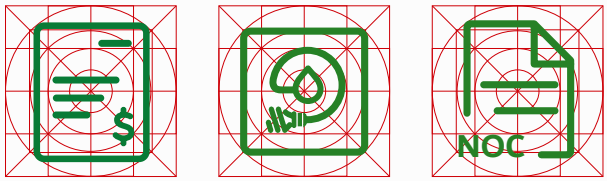
Applicable Platforms

Official Website Official App

Icons are visual representations used for services, actions, etc. to provide visual context and to enhance usability. We have set a proper foundation for creating simple, bold and aesthetically pleasing icons for DEWA.

Style and Colors

All the icons designed for DEWA need to follow a consistent style and color scheme. We use line style icons with a base thickness of 2px and a radius of 4 for the corners. The primary green is used for the icons.



Best Practices

- Always try to maintain consistency between the icons
- Always try to maintain a visual balance between all icons
- All elements must have a thickness of only 2px
- All elements must have a radius of 4 (except circles)
- Always first try to create icons using only shapes (Rounded rectangles, circles, etc)
- Always convert the icon to simplified paths in the end so that they may easily be converted to font icons for use on the website

Iconography 3/5

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

Icons are visual representations used for services, actions, etc. to provide visual context and to enhance usability. We have set a proper foundation for creating simple, bold and aesthetically pleasing icons for DEWA.

Current Icons

The new revamped dewa website consists of 5 main persona's, each of which contain service groups. Each of these main service groups has a dedicated icon as shown below.

Consumer


Billing


Supply Management


Consumption Management


Solar Community


Sustainability


EV Green Charger


General Services


Useful Links & Guides

Builder


Electricity Network Services


General Technical Services



NOC Services


Shams Dubai Guides & Tools


Useful Links & Guides


Water Network Services


Technical Discussion Support


Estimate Payment & Tracking

Iconography 4/5

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

Icons are visual representations used for services, actions, etc. to provide visual context and to enhance usability. We have set a proper foundation for creating simple, bold and aesthetically pleasing icons for DEWA.

Current Icons (Continued)

Partner


List of Partners


Partnership Management

Supplier


Useful Links & Guides


Main Services


Support Services

Student


DEWA Academy


Scholarships


Internship & Trainings

Iconography 5/5

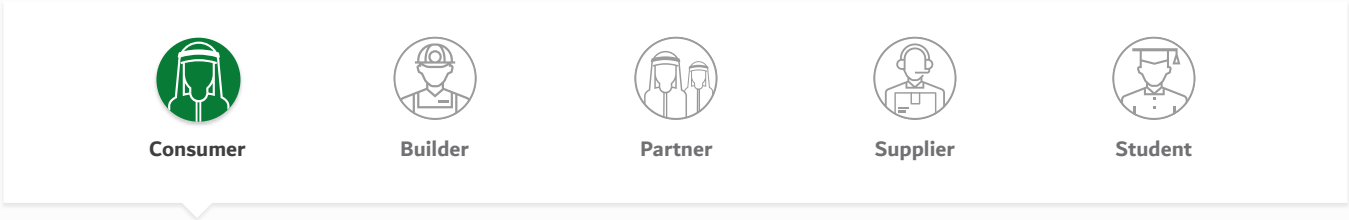
Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

Icons are visual representations used for services, actions, etc. to provide visual context and to enhance usability. We have set a proper foundation for creating simple, bold and aesthetically pleasing icons for DEWA.

Persona Icons

As mentioned earlier, the DEWA revamped website consists of 5 main user groups, or personas. Each of these is represented by an icon and its label shown below



• The selected icon is denoted by a primary green (#087B36) backround with white outlines for the icon.

• Unselected icons are shown in grey (#9B9B9B) on a white background

Hero Image Slider 1/6

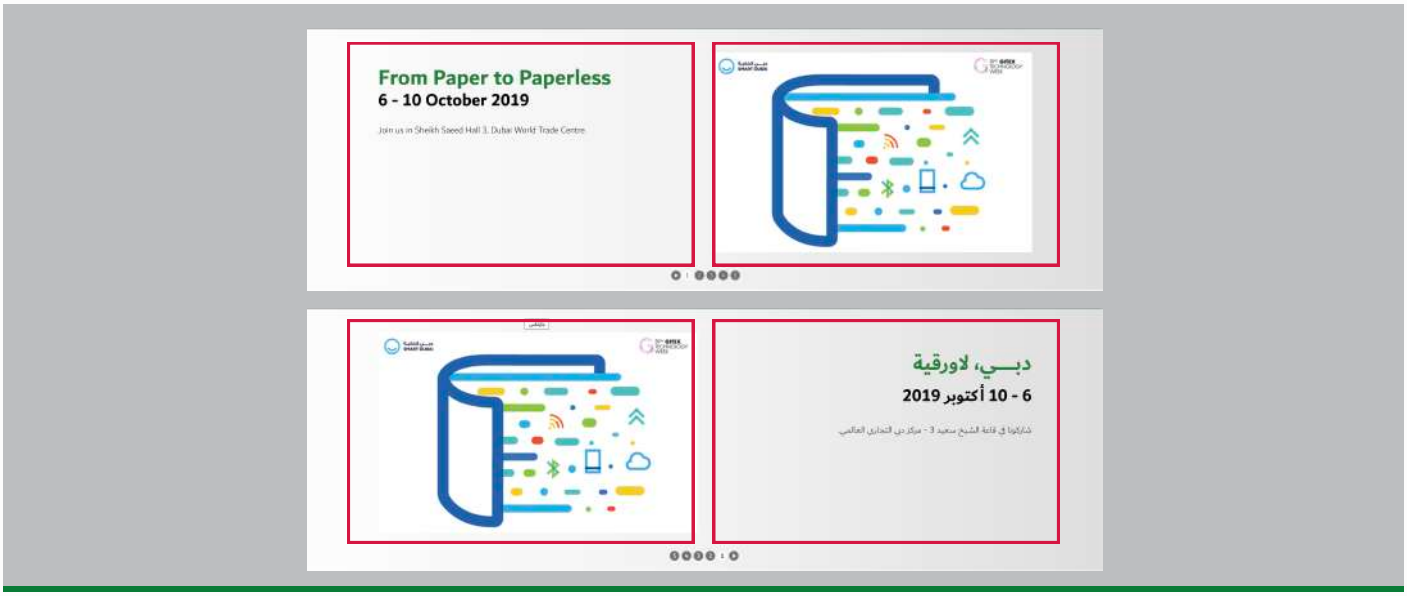
Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The hero image of any website is arguebly the most important part of any website. For the DEWA website we use sliders to display a number of hero images. To ensure consistency we have set proper guidelines for the images and texts used in the slider.

Structure

For the DEWA website, we have structured the slider in a specific way. It is divided into two parts, the hero image on the right side and the text on the left. This is to overcome problems encountered with having a full page hero image with text on top (images getting too dark because of the overlays, text unreadable, content not being conveyed properly)

Usage



Do.

- Always keep the image on the right for English and on the left for Arabic
- The text and image should never overlap

Hero Image Slider 2/6

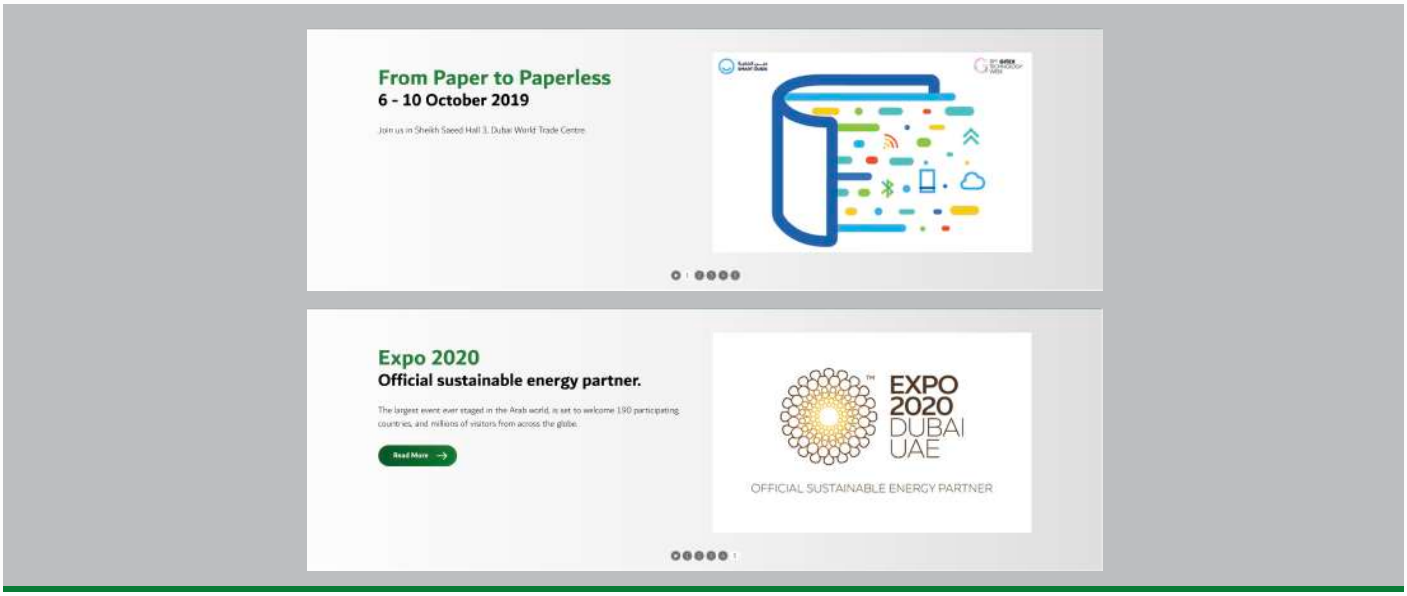
Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The hero image of any website is arguebly the most important part of any website. For the DEWA website we use sliders to display a number of hero images. To ensure consistency we have set proper guidelines for the images and texts used in the slider.

Image

The image used in the slider is one of the most important parts in the website landing page thus we have to ensure that the images used maintain consistency and follow the established guidelines.

Usage



Do.

- Ensure the image is in the aspect ratio of 8:5
- Maximum width of image is set at 668px and height at 418px
- Avoid placing small text in the image
- Do not place titles or information in the image itself
- Ensure good quality images are used but with a filesize of <350kb

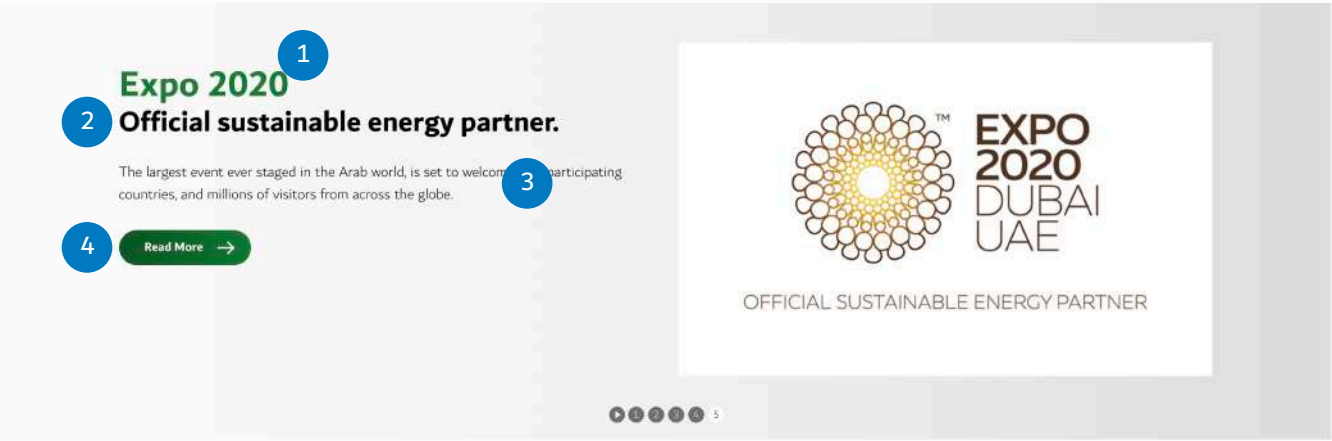
Hero Image Slider 3/6

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The hero image of any website is arguebly the most important part of any website. For the DEWA website we use sliders to display a number of hero images. To ensure consistency we have set proper guidelines for the images and texts used in the slider.

Text

The text used in the hero slider is divided into four parts. The Heading, subheading, description and links. The heading and description are mandatory while the subheading and links might be removed depending on the scenario (check below).



1. Main heading in primary green and bold weight
2. Sub heading in black and bold weight
3. Description in black and regular weight (ideally 2-3 lines of description)
4. May contain one link button, max two link buttons (2nd link for ‘Watch Video’)

Hero Image Slider 4/6

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The hero image of any website is arguebly the most important part of any website. For the DEWA website we use sliders to display a number of hero images. To ensure consistency we have set proper guidelines for the images and texts used in the slider.

Text (Continued)

The slider may or may not contain all of these depending on the scenario

Scenario 1: The heading is short enough to fit on one line

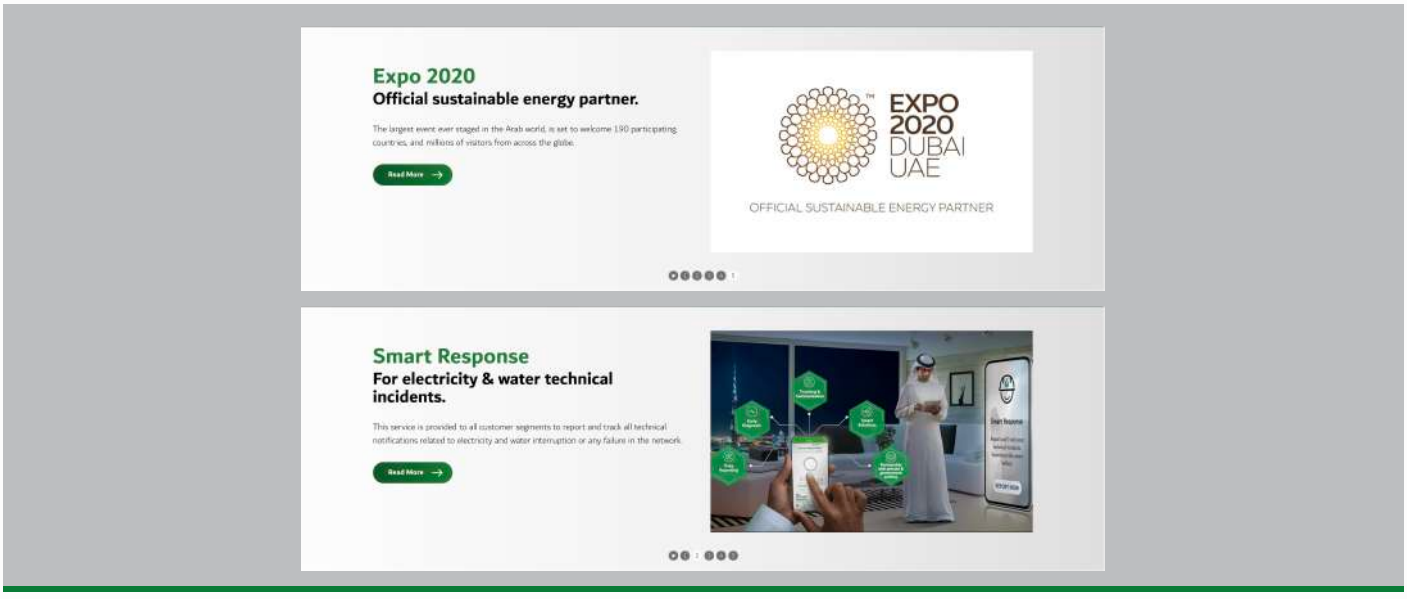
• the information panel is going to have one line of main heading and one line of subheading (ideally) or maximum two lines of subheading and the description

• Maximum characters for heading (green) = 20 (1 line)

• Maximum characters for sub heading (bold black) = 40 (1 line)

• Maximum characters for description = 250 (3 lines)

Usage



Do.

Hero Image Slider 5/6

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The hero image of any website is arguebly the most important part of any website. For the DEWA website we use sliders to display a number of hero images. To ensure consistency we have set proper guidelines for the images and texts used in the slider.

Text (Continued)

Scenario 2: When the heading is longer and has to go to two lines

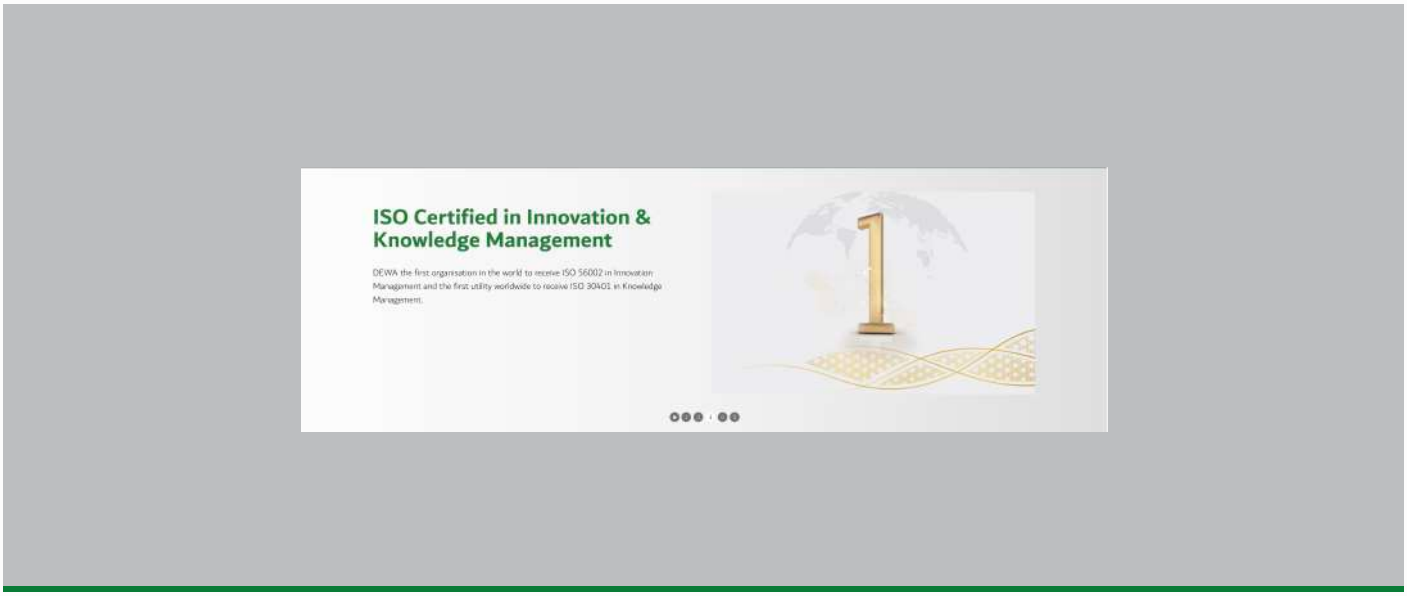
• The information panel is going to have only two lines of the main heading and the description. No subheading in this scenario

• Maximum characters for heading (green) = 40 (2 lines)

• No subheading in this scenario

• Maximum characters for description = 250 (Max 3 lines)

Usage



Do.

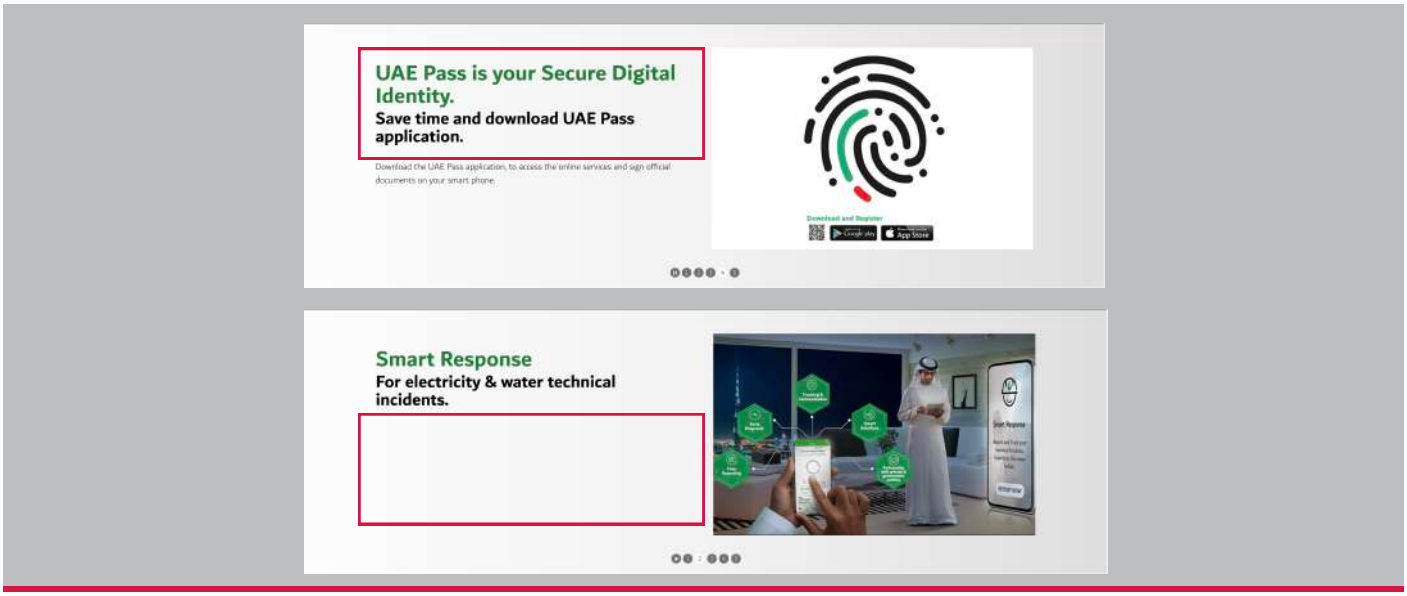
Hero Image Slider 6/6

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The hero image of any website is arguebly the most important part of any website. For the DEWA website we use sliders to display a number of hero images. To ensure consistency we have set proper guidelines for the images and texts used in the slider.

Text (Continued)

Usage



Dont.

- Break the guidelines for text e.g. using two lines of Heading with two lines of subheading
- Do not skip the desciption for the sliders
- Even if guidelines are met but a visual imbalance is seen e.g. the description is too short, it is advised to try and increase the content to make the slider more visually appealing

Forms 1/6

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

Forms are used to get information and allow users to enter data to be used by the application. When designing forms, it is important to keep in mind the structure and sequence, text, feedback and help aswell and not just the UI elements

Form Fields

Input Label

Input placeholder | Inactive empty field

Input Label

| Active empty field

Input Label

Input Te | Active filled field

Input Label

Input Text | Inactive filled field

Input Label

| Disabled field

Input Label

Input Text | Success validation field

Forms 2/6

Applicable Platforms
Official Website Official App

Forms are used to get information and allow users to enter data to be used by the application. When designing forms, it is important to keep in mind the structure and sequence, text, feedback and help aswell and not just the UI elements

Form Fields

Input Label

Input Text | Error field

Short clear and concise error message

The error message should clearly indicate what the mistake is and should also suggest the solution/ correct syntax.

Examples

Email Address

jamalkdewa.com

Please enter a valid email address. Example: johndoe@dewa.gov.ae

Phone Number

971 | 52781

Please enter a valid UAE phone number. Example: +971 52 781 8122

First Name

Jamal34

First Name cannot contain Special Characters or Numbers

Forms 3/6

Applicable Platforms

Official Website Official App

Forms are used to get information and allow users to enter data to be used by the application. When designing forms, it is important to keep in mind the structure and sequence, text, feedback and help aswell and not just the UI elements

Form Fields (Continued)

Input Label

| (Optional) Active field with help text

Help text appears when field is active

Input Label

| (Optional) Active field with help link

Help link appears when field is active

The help should contain precise information to help the user fill the field. Show proper syntax/format if applicable

Examples

Email Address

Example: johndoe@dewa.gov.ae

Phone Number

Example: +971 52 781 8122

Forms 4/6

Applicable Platforms

Official Website Official App

Forms are used to get information and allow users to enter data to be used by the application. When designing forms, it is important to keep in mind the structure and sequence, text, feedback and help aswell and not just the UI elements

Form Fields (Continued)

Select Label

Select placeholder

| Inactive dropdown field

Select Label

Option One

Option Two

Option Three

Option Four

Option Five

Option Six

| Active dropdown field

Forms 5/6

Applicable Platforms
Official Website Official App

Forms are used to get information and allow users to enter data to be used by the application. When designing forms, it is important to keep in mind the structure and sequence, text, feedback and help aswell and not just the UI elements

Form Fields (Continued)

Radio Group Label

- Option One
- Option Two
- Option Three
- Option Four

Checkbox Label

- [ ] Option One
- [x] Option Two
- [ ] Option Three
- [x] Option Four

| Radiobutton and checkbox

Textarea Label

Textarea placeholder

| Textarea field

Upload Files

Drag files here
or browse your computer

| Upload files field

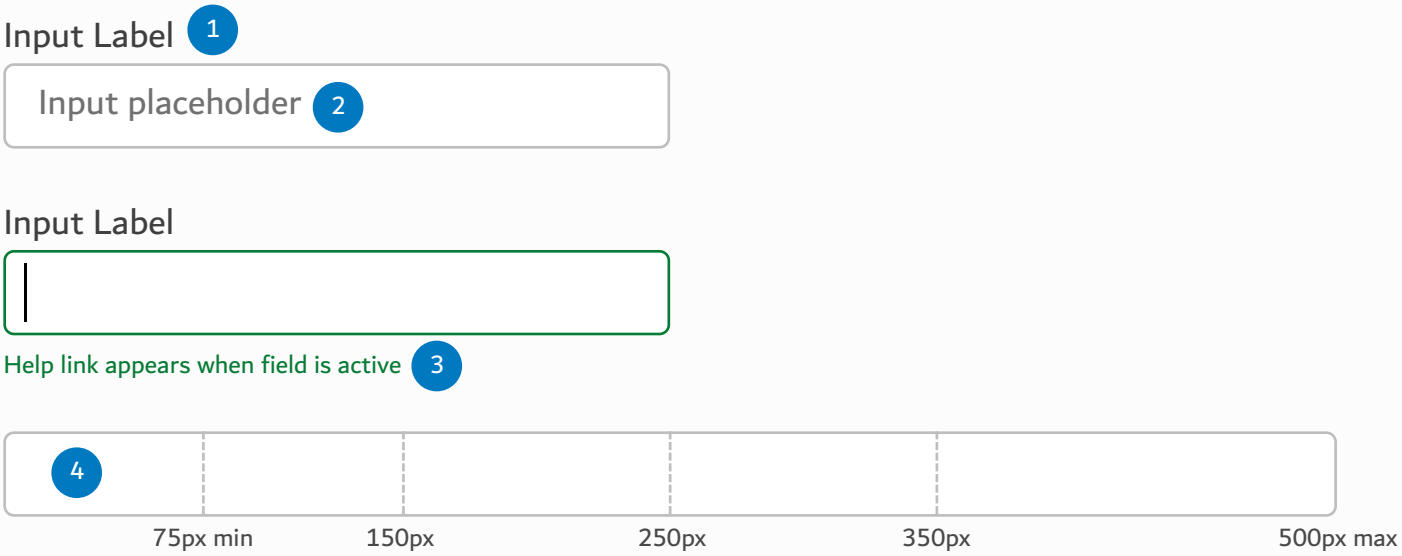
Forms 6/6

Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

Forms are used to get information and allow users to enter data to be used by the application. When designing forms, it is important to keep in mind the structure and sequence, text, feedback and help aswell and not just the UI elements

Form Field Anatomy



1. Standard label alignment is left-aligned. Use clear and concise labels
2. Standard placeholder is left-aligned with sentence case format. Use informative placeholders that show the user how to use the field clearly
3. Help text/ help links provide further context for the field. These should only appear when the field is active. Use this to provide examples or specific syntax for fields when required. Avoid overusing this
4. The field length should reflect its content. Choose the length that matches closely with the maximum length of input for that field. Use only the given lengths to maintain visual consistency. These lengths apply to other similar fields, such as text fields and dropdowns

Other Components 1/11

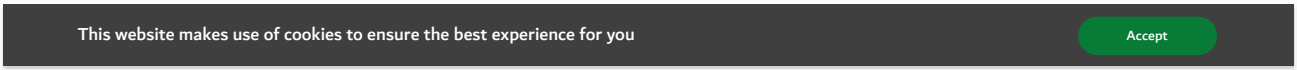
Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Banners

Use banners at the top of the screen to display informational, error or warning messages. Banners should appear one at a time and require user action to be dismissed

Cookie Banner



- Use for taking user acknowledgment for usage of cookies
- Should appear only once in the users lifetime unless the browser cache is cleared

Information Banner



- Use for displaying informational messages to the user

Warning Banner



- Use for warning users of change or reminding them of actions they may need to take
- Inform users clearly of the intended action to take but don't use alarming language
- If the message contains a compulsary action to be taken by the user, the banner should not be dismissible until the user takes action or the message is timed out

Other Components 2/11

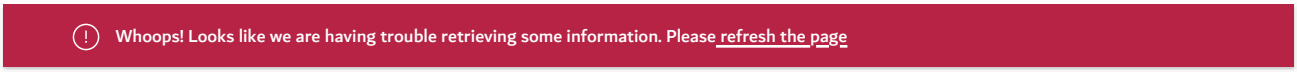
Applicable Platforms
Official Website

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Banners

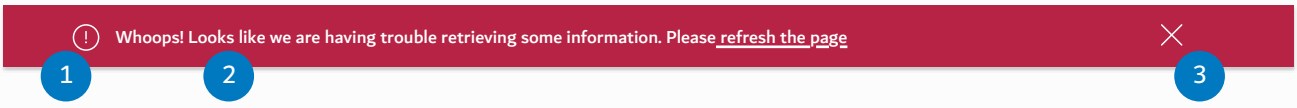
Use banners at the top of the screen to display informational, error or warning messages. Banners should appear one at a time, and may or may not be dismissible.

Error Banner



- Use only for critical error messages after something has gone wrong
- Explain clearly the problem and the next steps to be taken by the user
- Most commonly these type of banners should not be dismissible untill the user performs the stated corrective action

Banner Anatomy



1. Icon denoting the type of message. ‘i’ icon for information. This is important for color blind people to know whether it is a warning or informational message
2. A short, clear and concise message
3. Close button. May or may not be included depending on the nature of the message

Other Components 3/11

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Website Header

A universal header is maintained across all dewa web channels for consistency and easy of access. Use this header for the main website or any other dewa portals that are linked to the website e.g. SAP portals.



1. The index menu is a key feature of the website and must always be accessible in any web platform
2. Important links here can vary and are subject to change with the exception of the home and contact us links which should always be available. The maximum number of links here can be 4. But ideally should be kept at 3 or lower.
3. Additional icons for language change, accessibility and search should always be here and easily accessible by the user. In certain viewing formats such as for ipad and mobile, these links can be moved to the index menu





Each of these items in the header needs to have an on hover effect for maximum visability.

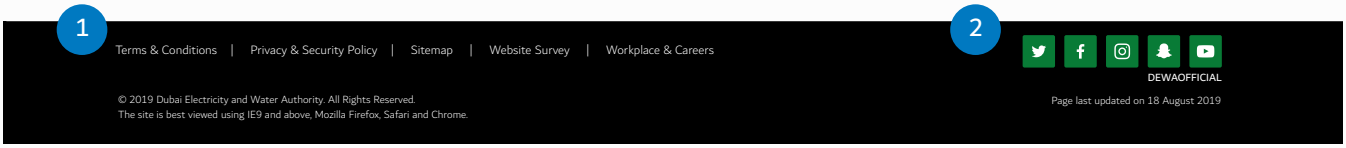
Other Components 4/11

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Website Footer

A universal footer is maintained across all dewa web channels for consistency and easy of access. Use this footer for the main website or any other dewa portals that are linked to the website e.g. SAP portals.



1. Additional links for policies, sitemap, careers etc. Links may be added here but make sure that these links are not of high priority to regular users since the footer is located at the bottom of the screen and is rarely accessed by users.
2. Media links should be linked to the relavant social media page of DEWA

Useful Links

In certain pages, a useful links module is added just above the footer. This module is compulsary on the landing page



1. If the links are more than 5 (or limited by screen size as in mobile view), a carousel is added. Otherwise the links should be fixed in place without a carousel

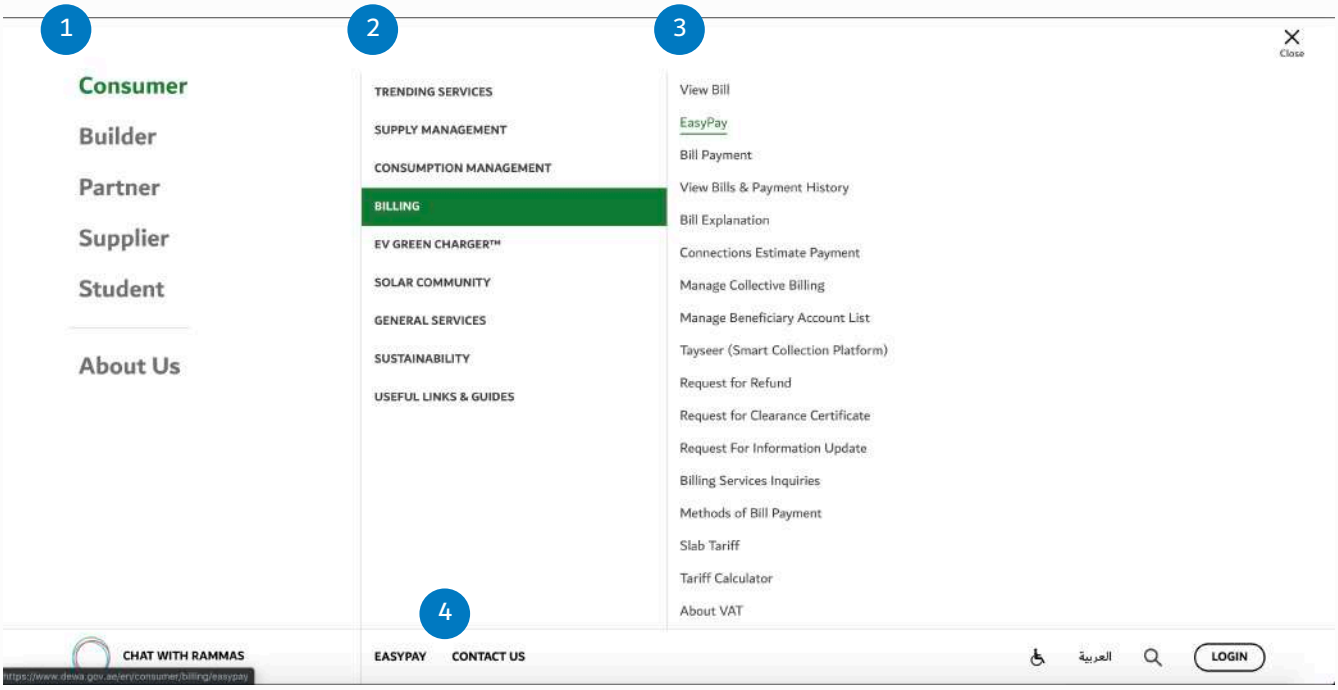
Other Components 5/11

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Index Menu

The index menu is an integral part of the new DEWA website, providing instant and easy access to all DEWA services from anywhere in the website



1. Level A menu for persona level and about us
2. Level B menu for service groupings. Use these to cluster services together to make it easier for the user to navigate
3. Level C menu for services. These are the last level of navigation and will redirect the user to the selected link
4. Important links. Should match the links on the header

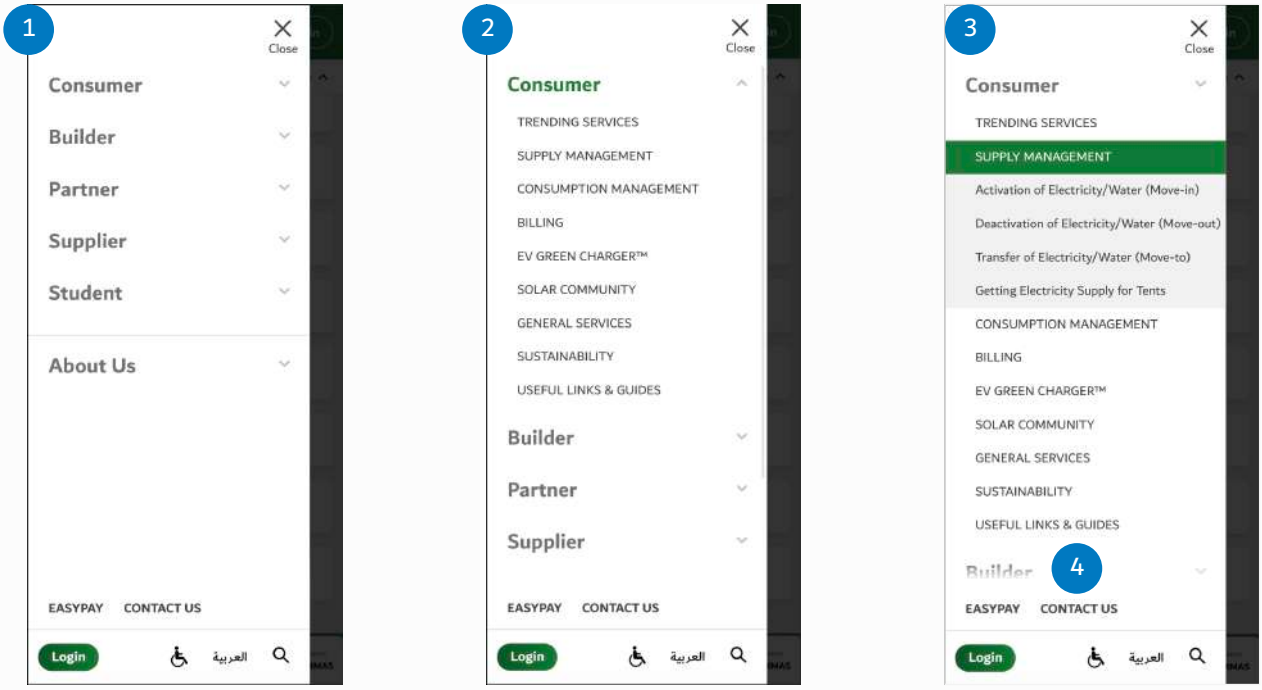
Other Components 6/11

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Index Menu Mobile View

The index menu is designed to adapt to smaller screens for ipad and mobile while still providing the same level of ease of navigation to the user



1. Default view shows level A menu's with all submenu's menus collapsed
2. Tapping on a level A menu expands the level B menu's
3. Tapping on a level B menu expands the level C menu
4. Fading out content at the bottom to show users that more information is available on scrolling down

Other Components 7/11

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Cards

The DEWA website makes use of card style designs for displaying alot of its content. While the internal structure of these cards may change depending on the variation, it is important to keep a consistent overall design for all the cards e.g. the 5px rounded corners, the box shadow, the width and the alignment. Some of the variations are shown below.

News Module

02 OCT 2019

Emirates Literature Foundation Welcomes DEWA As Official Sustainability Partner for the year 2019

Emirates Literature Foundation and Dubai Electricity and Water Authority (DEWA) announced today the signing of a new agreement which sees DEWA become the Official Sustainability Partner for the Emirates Airline Festival of Literature, the largest and...

News Module (On hover)

02 OCT 2019

Emirates Literature Foundation Welcomes DEWA As Official Sustainability Partner for the year 2019

Emirates Literature Foundation and Dubai Electricity and Water Authority (DEWA) announced today the signing of a new agreement which sees DEWA become the Official Sustainability Partner for the Emirates Airline Festival of Literature, the largest and...

Other Components 8/11

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

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Cards (Continued)

Initiatives Module

DEWA & Expo 2020

DEWA is the Official Sustainable Energy Partner of Expo 2020 Dubai and will provide this global event with electricity and water from October 2020 to April 2021.

Initiatives Module (On hover)

DEWA & Expo 2020

DEWA is the Official Sustainable Energy Partner of Expo 2020 Dubai and will provide this global event with electricity and water from October 2020 to April 2021.

Engage with us Module

DEWA & Expo 2020

Submit your ideas to make a difference and shape the future

Engage with us Module (On hover)

DEWA & Expo 2020

Submit your ideas to make a difference and shape the future

Other Components 9/11

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Cards (Continued)

Services Module

Technical Discussion Support

- Request Call back
- Request Email
- Request SMS
- Request Online Meeting

Services Module (On hover)

Technical Discussion Support

- Request Call back
- Request Email
- Request SMS
- Request Online Meeting

Services Module (Special service)

Supply Management

- Request for Activation of Electricity
- Request for Deactivation of Electricity

Smart Response

Report and track your technical incidents

Services Module (Special service - on hover)

Supply Management

- Request for Activation of Electricity
- Request for Deactivation of Electricity

Smart Response

Report and track your technical incidents

Other Components 10/11

Applicable Platforms
Official Website

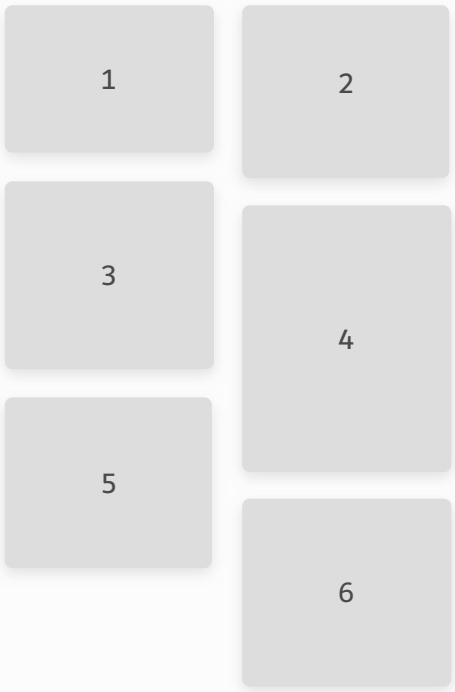
The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Layout for Services Module Cards

Services Module Layout for Web



Services Module Layout for Ipad



- Masonry card style layout
- 3 max columns for web and 2 for Ipad
- Horizontal indexing
- Fixed width but variable height depending on content

Other Components 11/11

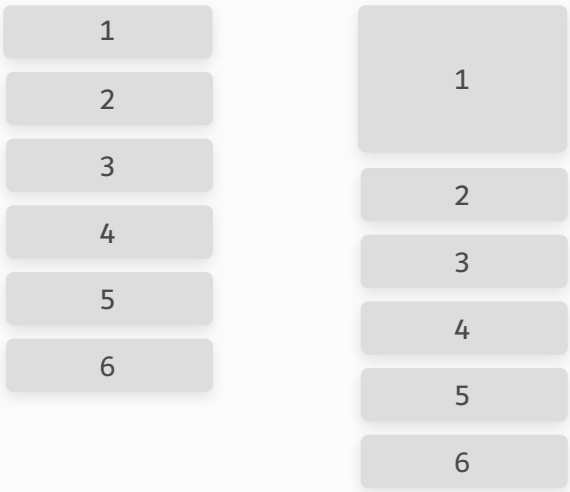
Applicable Platforms

Official Website | Official App

The DEWA website is created with scalability and change in mind. Thus components are created where possible to be reused throughout the site to maintain consistency and to save development cost and time

Layout for Services Module Cards (Continued)

Services Module Layout for Mobile View and Mobile App



- Vertically stacked card layout
- 1 max colum
- Collapsed by default
- Can expand only one card at a time
- Fixed width but variable height depending on content